When I woke on the morning of the twenty-sixth, there was six inches down and it was still snowing. It was all I needed to see. I called up Roy and canceled the museum bit. Unbelievably, he argued with me. I was adamant. I know a major snowstorm when I see one, and neither Machlowitz nor the Weather Bureau could argue me out of it.

So we stayed home and, on and off, watched the snow pile up to a record one-day fall of twenty-six inchesl* It stopped the city cold.

As I think back on it, I am amazed at how little it affected us. It was the Christmas season, so I didn't have to go in to school. There was no work that had to be done there anyway, and it was best for me to be at home working on my dissertation, which I had been doing for a couple of months now and which was going along swimmingly.

We had no automobile so we didn't have to worry about digging it out. We had no children so we didn't have to worry about milk supplies or anything like that. For that matter, we had plenty of canned food in the house and all was well.

It was, in fact, a rather pleasant day for us as we watched the blanket of snow come down, turning the city quiet and peaceful and clean and white. It was a day on which even the candy store could have been closed. I don't think that ever again was I in a position to watch a

4 The Weather Bureau managed to stay two inches ahead of the fall all day long, promising an end that never seemed to come.

major snowstorm without having to be concerned and worried in a dozen different ways.

The year that ended in snow was a rather icy one from the standpoint of my writing career. I had sold three stories in 1947 as compared with two the year before, and one of my 1947 sales had been quite a long one. Nevertheless, there had been no anthology sales, no Orson Welles money (no "subsidiary sales," in short), and the disappointment of "Grow Old with Me." I ended the year with $710, just a hair under the 1946 mark.

I had entered Columbia University as a freshman at fifteen. I celebrated my twenty-eighth birthday on January 2, 1948, and I was still at Columbia.